



YOU ARE **24 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**

111 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

From this week, brown fat is laid down in your baby's neck, chest, and back to be used after birth to produce heat and energy. At the moment, they have no control over their temperature, which is efficiently maintained at a perfect level by the placenta.

“This week, think about starting discussions with your employer about your upcoming maternity leave.”

Since you're more than halfway through your pregnancy by now and are likely showing, you've probably already told your boss that you're pregnant. But just informing your company isn't enough—you need to know all the details that pertain to your upcoming maternity leave and what will happen if you decide to stop working before the baby is born. Every company has different guidelines; some include paid maternity leave while others do not. Talk with a human resources representative to discuss your company's policies on maternity leave and time off. If paid time off isn't available, your company may allow you to use paid vacation days or sick leave, and you may be eligible for Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) leave.

To take advantage of the FMLA, you must have worked for an employer at least 12 months (1,250 hours over the past 12 months), and work where the company employs 50 or more people within 75 miles. You may take up to 12 weeks of leave in a 12-month period.

ASK A DOCTOR

What does “small for gestational age” mean? It means your baby appears to be small for your stage of pregnancy, but it doesn't mean there's a problem. You'll be given a scan to accurately measure and check your baby.

Sometimes slow growth is due to fetal growth restriction (FGR), because of a problem with the placenta, affecting the amount of oxygen and nutrients reaching the baby. [Preeclampsia](#) can cause FGR, as can lifestyle factors such as smoking, drinking alcohol, and taking recreational drugs.

STRETCHY SKIN

You may have developed stretch marks due to your skin stretching rapidly as you gain pregnancy weight. Initially, these marks are pinky/red and can be itchy. After pregnancy, stretch